

EG Pakistan: Ceasefire collapse will extend cycle of low-level conflict with Afghanistan

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【要点】

- ・4月の停戦中にタリバン系民兵とパキスタン軍は戦闘再開の準備を進め、最近のパキスタン軍事施設への攻撃がその証拠となっている。
- ・アフガニスタンのタリバン政権は敵対行為の一時停止を望んでいるが、傘下のテフreek・イ・タリバン・パキスタン（TTP）への影響力が限定的であり、国内政治上の理由からパキスタンの越境攻撃に報復する必要がある。
- ・TTPとパキスタン軍は互いに対する強制行動以外の戦略を持たないため、紛争は継続することが確実である。
- ・中国が仲介した4月の停戦は、タリバン政権がTTPをアフガニスタンから排除するという前提に基づいていたが、全当事者は停戦を単なる紛争の一時停止と見なしていた。
- ・現在の戦闘ラウンドは資源不足のため大幅にエスカレートする可能性は低いが、TTPはパキスタン治安部隊への攻撃を再開し、都市部での爆弾テロなど一定の閾値を超えると限定的な衝突が引き起こされるパターンが続くと予想される。

【メール原文】

Pakistan

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Ceasefire collapse will extend cycle of low-level conflict with Afghanistan

Short-term trajectory:

Long-term trajectory:

* Taliban-affiliated militants and the Pakistani military used an April ceasefire to prepare for renewed fighting, as publicly evidenced by the recent attack on a major Pakistani military installation.

* The Taliban regime in Afghanistan wants a pause in hostilities, but it has little leverage over its affiliate, the Tehreek-e-Taliban Pakistan (TTP), and, for domestic political reasons, must retaliate against Pakistani cross-border strikes.

* The TTP and the Pakistani military have no strategy other than coercive action against each other, ensuring that the conflict will continue.

Both sides used the ceasefire to prepare for the next round of fighting. A TTP splinter group called the Jamaat-ul-Ahrar has claimed responsibility for the attack on the Pakistani Rangers headquarters in Karachi that killed three people. Although Jamaat-ul-Ahrar has existed since 2014, it operates as a subsidiary of the TTP and has never shown the ability to carry out an attack so far from Afghanistan. Islamabad does not distinguish between the two groups. Pakistan's strategy to contain the TTP is inherently escalatory. It centers on strikes inside Afghanistan to pressure the Taliban regime in Kabul to rein in the TTP; however, that approach leads to the involvement of Afghan government forces in the attacks on the Pakistani military.

The ceasefire that China mediated in April rested on a shaky premise: that the Taliban regime in Kabul would prevent the TTP from finding sanctuary in Afghanistan. In the end, all sides viewed the ceasefire as little more than a pause in the conflict. Pakistan saw an opportunity to preempt future TTP attacks. The Taliban's claim that the TTP had accepted the ceasefire was never endorsed by the TTP. By May, both sides had resumed skirmishing, with Pakistani soldiers attacking TTP encampments along the border. The ground fighting intensified through June. The Karachi attack indicates the TTP now treats the ceasefire as defunct and shows little concern about the Taliban regime's position. An open attack on a heavily protected military installation in Pakistan's largest city made it impossible for the government to downplay the incident, prompting the airstrikes that followed.

Kabul and Islamabad lack the resources for more than renewed skirmishing. The current round of fighting is unlikely to escalate further, but the TTP will probably resume its attacks on Pakistani security targets. Once those attacks cross a certain threshold—such as bombings in major cities—they will likely trigger limited clashes between Pakistani and Taliban forces. That pattern has held for the past two years and will probably continue (see: Resource constraints will limit conflict with Afghanistan despite intensifying skirmishes , 27 February 2026).

Of the three parties, the Taliban-led Afghan government is the strongest supporter of a ceasefire but has the least influence over the conflict. Kabul cannot afford conflict when its economy is reeling from severe drought, external funders such as Qatar face financial strain from the Iran war, and the government seeks stronger ties with China—one of the country's few foreign investors. The Afghan government has limited leverage over the TTP, but it also cannot appear to be backing down to Pakistan. Nonetheless, its response this week was largely symbolic; Pakistan claimed that only four drones were launched. Pakistan also cannot afford a larger conflict. It faces fiscal constraints under its IMF loan regime, along with a hostile India, an unstable border with Iran, and domestic insurgencies.

Pakistan and the TTP see no alternatives to military action. Pakistan has limited its response to TTP attacks to airstrikes and economic sanctions. While these measures have damaged Afghanistan's economy, they have also hardened Afghan opinion against Pakistan. Any goodwill that the Taliban once held toward Islamabad because of years of covert Pakistani support has evaporated. The Pakistani military has also not been able to target the TTP directly, and its repeated strikes on the Taliban-led Afghan government have made diplomacy ineffective.

The TTP, by contrast, believes that its strategy of targeting Pakistani security targets and courting disaffected groups inside Pakistan is succeeding. It has gained support among Pashtuns, the ethnic group in northwest Pakistan that is related to the TTP's tribal base, and is supporting Baloch insurgents in southwest Pakistan (see: Military will struggle to contain escalating insurgency in Balochistan , 6

February 2026). The group has also expanded its ability to carry out suicide attacks beyond the northwest border region to the rest of the country.

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